True Steele

FUNDRAISING INTELLIGENCE SPRINT

True Steele + SF Education Fund

Prepared for

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CONFIDENTIAL

THE SITUATION

The San Francisco Education Fund has mobilized community support for SFUSD students for over 40 years, distributing $3M+ in resources annually. Now, through the San Francisco Literacy Coalition (SFLC), SFEF is tackling one of the district's most pressing challenges: pre-K through 5th grade literacy outcomes.

The early results speak for themselves. The $3M Crankstart grant validated the model, and in just five months, SFLC **doubled the share of students meeting grade-level expectations: from 24% to 54%.** But scaling from two pilot schools to district-wide impact requires significant new funding, and SFEF has identified two critical gaps:

> **1. Institutional funding pipeline for SFLC.** The coalition needs three or more additional anchor supporters. Identifying, qualifying, and prioritizing the right institutional funders is time-intensive work that competes with daily development operations.

> **2. Individual donor intelligence.** SFEF's donor base has more capacity than your team can currently see. Without a systematic way to assess who can give more, who's ready to be asked, and who needs cultivation first, effort gets spread too thin.

AI-powered research can close both gaps: find the right prospects faster, and give your team the context to approach them well.

WHAT WE'LL DELIVER

A three-week Fundraising Intelligence Sprint that produces two deliverables your team can act on immediately:

Deliverable 1: SFLC Institutional Funding Strategy

A prioritized prospect list of 25–40 institutional funders (foundations, corporate funders, government programs) with high alignment to the Literacy Coalition's mission, geography, and funding stage, plus a recommended approach strategy for the top 10.

Includes:

- Funder landscape scan using AI-powered research across grant databases, 990 filings, and public records
- Qualification scoring based on giving history, focus area match, grant size fit, and geographic alignment
- Prioritized prospect list with capacity estimates, key contacts, and connection pathways
- Approach strategy memo for top 10 prospects with tailored messaging angles and timing recommendations
- Draft LOIs for all top-ranked funders, ready for your team to review, refine, and submit
- For funders with open grant opportunities: draft answers to application questions that your team can use as a starting point for final submissions

Deliverable 2: Individual Donor Heat Map

A scored and segmented analysis of SFEF's individual donor base, identifying the highest-potential donors for cultivation, upgrade, and major gift conversations.

Includes:

- Data enrichment of donor records using public data sources (LinkedIn, FEC political donations, real estate, philanthropic activity)
- Donor scoring across four dimensions: giving capacity, propensity to give, affinity to SFEF/SFLC mission, and relationship warmth
- Tiered segmentation: "ready to ask," "cultivate first," "long-term," and "steward"
- Heat map visualization showing where the highest-potential donors cluster
- Top 20 donor profiles with personalized cultivation recommendations
- Draft outreach messages for top prospects, ready for your team to personalize and send

SCOPE BOUNDARIES

To be clear about the line: True Steele will prepare the materials your team needs to move quickly on both funders and donors. That includes draft LOIs, draft application answers,

approach strategies, and draft outreach messages for top individual prospects. What we won't do is submit applications, send outreach on SFEF's behalf, manage donor relationships, or implement a CRM system or ongoing data pipeline. Your team owns the final drafts, the sends, and the relationships.

These deliverables make your development team sharper, not busier. Instead of spreading effort across every possible lead, you'll know exactly where to focus.

TIMELINE

WEEK	DATES	ACTIVITIES	MILESTONE
Kickoff	Mar 10	60-min kickoff session with Laura, Ann, and Terrence. Align on goals, data access, and SFLC funding priorities.	Data handoff
Week 1	Mar 10–14	Data intake and enrichment. Ingest donor records, run enrichment pipeline, begin institutional funder scan.	Preliminary findings
Week 2	Mar 17–21	Analysis and scoring. Complete donor scoring model, finalize institutional prospect list, develop approach strategies.	Draft deliverables
Week 3	Mar 24–28	Refinement and presentation. Incorporate feedback, finalize all deliverables, present findings to leadership.	Final presentation

Note: All deliverables will be completed and presented by March 28.

INVESTMENT

Option A: Institutional Funding Strategy $12,000

SFLC institutional funder prospect list and approach strategy only (Deliverable 1).

Best if: SFEF's immediate priority is securing SFLC anchor funders and individual donor analysis can wait.

RECOMMENDED

Option B: Full Fundraising Intelligence Sprint $22,000

Both deliverables (SFLC institutional funding strategy + individual donor heat map) plus an interactive donor intelligence dashboard your development team can use on an ongoing basis to query, filter, and explore donor data. Built on the same platform that powers Kindora's AI intelligence engine, adapted for SFEF's donor base.

Best if: SFEF wants a complete fundraising intelligence upgrade (strategy, data, and a lasting tool) in a single sprint.

Option C: Intelligence Sprint + Implementation Partnership **$32,000**

Everything in Option B, plus a 60-day implementation partnership to ensure the strategy translates into action:

- **Strategic advisory** - five hours per month for 60 days, available for donor conversation coaching, funder approach review, and dashboard guidance
- **Board presentation deck** - a customized presentation for SFEF's next board meeting, translating the sprint findings into a board-ready fundraising narrative
- **90-day cultivation calendar** - a sequenced action plan for who to contact, when, and with what message, covering both institutional funders and top individual donor prospects
- **Donor data refresh** - one updated scoring cycle at the 60-day mark to reflect new donor activity and outreach outcomes

Best if: SFEF wants hands-on strategic support through the first round of outreach and a polished board presentation to build internal alignment.

Payment terms: 50% at signing, 50% upon delivery of final presentation.

WHAT SFEF PROVIDES

- Access to donor database (export from CRM (Salesforce, Bloomerang, or spreadsheet))
- 60 minutes with Laura/Ann for kickoff alignment
- 30 minutes with Terrence on SFLC funding priorities and coalition structure
- Feedback on draft deliverables within 48 hours (Week 2)
- A stakeholder group for the final presentation (Week 3)

WHY TRUE STEELE

I've spent my career building the four things this engagement requires:

Philanthropy Operations

As Google.org's Americas Director, I directed $500M+ in strategic philanthropy and led the $100M Career Certificates Fund. I serve on the Board of Trustees of the San Francisco Foundation, one of the largest community foundations in the country. I understand how institutional funders evaluate opportunities, because I am one.

AI-Powered Fundraising Intelligence

As Co-Founder and CEO of Kindora, I've spent the past year building AI-powered fundraising intelligence tools that go deeper than Instrumentl, Candid, or Kindsight. The donor intelligence methodology in this sprint draws directly from that production platform.

Network Intelligence at Scale

I've built a working system that enriches, scores, and maps 2,900+ contacts across donor capacity, relationship warmth, and ask readiness, combining LinkedIn data, FEC political donations, real estate records, communication history, and AI-powered scoring. This sprint adapts that same methodology to SFEF's donor base.

Education Equity

At Google.org, I funded the $10M Rising STEM Scholars initiative (doubling Black and Latinx AP STEM enrollment in Bay Area schools), invested $3M in The Hidden Genius Project for Black male youth in Oakland, and supported the Roses in Concrete Community School with a culturally relevant CS curriculum in East Oakland. Earlier, I led strategy at Year Up and taught as an adjunct professor at Northern Virginia Community College.

NEXT STEPS

1. **Review this proposal.** Happy to walk through it on a 30-minute call this week.
2. **Sign and return by March 7** to begin the kickoff week of March 10.
3. **Provide donor data export** so we can hit the ground running at kickoff.

SFEF's 40-year track record and SFLC's early results are the kind of story funders want to back: a model that works, ready to grow. What we build together will help you tell that story to the right people at the right time.

True Steele

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